



Tongue Posture & Swallowing

The resting position that quietly shapes the face and airway.

Where should the tongue rest?

At rest, the whole tongue should sit gently against the roof of the mouth — the tip just behind the front teeth on "the spot," with the lips sealed and teeth slightly apart. This light, constant pressure helps guide the upper jaw to grow wide and forward, supporting a roomier airway and a balanced bite.

SIGNS OF LOW TONGUE POSTURE OR TONGUE THRUST

- Tongue resting low in the mouth or against the teeth
- Tongue pushing forward when swallowing or speaking
- Open mouth at rest and frequent mouth breathing
- Messy or effortful swallowing; speech sound differences
- A narrow palate, crowded teeth, or an open bite

TIP

Try this: find "the spot"

Make a light "click" or say "n-n-n." Feel where the tip of your tongue touches just behind your top front teeth — that ridge is "the spot." Rest the tip there and gently suction the rest of the tongue up to the palate.

FOUNDATIONAL EXERCISES

- Spot hold — rest the tongue tip on the spot for 60 seconds
- Suction hold — suction the whole tongue to the palate and hold
- Tongue "pop" — release the suction to make a clean pop

Why it matters long-term

Healthy tongue posture supports facial growth, a stable bite, clearer speech, and an open airway. A myofunctional therapist can confirm whether a tongue-tie or habit is limiting posture and tailor exercises to you.

This guide is for general education only and is not a substitute for individualized medical or dental advice, diagnosis, or treatment. For a personalized assessment, please reach out to Myo Family Health.

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